3. The term dhamma occurs about 111 times in Ashoka's edicts. See Hiltebeitel (2011).

4. Line E of Rock Edict VIII at Kalsi. Hultzsch (1925): 37.

5. *Mahabharata*, Vanaparva, chapter 238, shloka 5 and shloka 20. Cited in Bose (1998): 114–15.

6. Lines 4–7 of Erragudi Rock Edict III, in Sircar (1979): 17.

7. See Lamotte (1988): 230–3 for the similarities between the advice that Ashoka gave and that of the Buddha. So, for instance, he points out: 'In the field of domestic virtues, Asoka unceasingly counselled obedience to one's father and mother, obedience to one's teachers, irreproachable courtesy towards one's friends, acquaintances, companions and family, kindness to the poor, the old and the weak as well as to slaves and servants, generosity towards brahmins and sramanas. The Buddha gave exactly the same advice to the young householder Singalaka: "How does the noble disciple protect the six regions of space? These six regions are composed as follows: father and mother are the east; teachers are the south; sons and wife are the west; friends and companions are the north; slaves and servants are the nadir; sramanas and brahmins are the zenith."'

8. Line I, Erragudi Edict IV, in Sircar (1979): 27.

9. Line III, ibid.

10. Line V, ibid.

11. Line XIV, Erragudi Rock Edict V, in Sircar (1979): 24.

12. For the various classes of people whose welfare and happiness was the concern of this class of officials, Lines X–XIII, ibid.

13. Lines II–VIII of Erragudi Edict VI, ibid.: 18–19.

14. *AS* 1.19.28. Kangle (1972): pt II, 47.

15. *AS* 1.20.22. Kangle (1972): pt II, 51.

16. *AS* 1.19.34–5. Kangle (1972): pt II, 47.

17. This is a different view from that of scholars who see the genesis of Ashoka's welfare measures in his Buddhist faith. S.J. Tambiah, for instance, argued that 'Asokan political Buddhism and social ethics committed kingship and state to the creation of welfare facilities and a prosperous society as the precondition for the support of monastic institutions, and for the escape from suffering and the realization of moral law (the *Dhamma*) in the society as a whole.' Tambiah (1973): 5.

18. For a description of the engraved rocks, Hultzsch (1925): xii.

19. Falk (2006): 111.